

Lumiere Research Scholar Evaluation

Student Name

ODON INEZA

Title of final research paper

Predictive Technologies and Justice: Risk Assessment Algorithms,
Governance, and Accountability in Sub-Saharan Africa.

Mentor name & university:

Oluwabunmi Adaramola, University of Leeds.

Lumiere Education certifies the authenticity and originality of the research paper as well as the enclosed feedback.

Describe in brief, the nature of the scholar's research paper and your work with the student.

The paper critically assesses and evaluates the use of predictive technologies and AI systems within the judicial system and processes in Africa, particularly drawing upon case studies on the use of AI in Kenya and Rwanda. Particularly, through a comparative analysis, the paper evaluates the transformative nature of AI to the African judicial process. The research is situated within a larger conversation about Africa's readiness to responsibly embrace AI across sectors, particularly in justice reform.

For the duration of the research programme, I worked closely with Odon to support the development of his research project through a combination of academic guidance, research development support, particularly as Odon balanced competing priorities such as his internship. I supported him in refining his research ideas and how they aligned with his objectives. I consistently encouraged critical thinking, time management and independent decision-making throughout the research mentoring programme.

The Lumiere “Four Cs” Evaluation Framework

Please use the table below to rate the scholar in the following areas.

Mark each column with (x)

		Excellent	Good	Average	Below Average	Poor
Creativity	How would you describe the scholar's ability to create innovative and unique approaches to ideas and concepts?	X				
Communication	How would you rate the scholar's verbal & written communication?	X				

Consistency & Commitment	How would you rate the scholar's ability to keep up with deadlines & expectations?		X			
Content Expertise	How would you describe the scholar's knowledge of their topic of research or growth in the topic area of research?		X			

Please rate this scholar's potential for undergraduate-level academic work at a top college/university:

Mark the selected column with (x)

One of the best I have encountered (Top 5%)	
Excellent (Top 10%)	X
Very good (Top 25%)	
Good (Top 50%)	
Below average (Under 50%)	

Please evaluate the following in detail

1. Describe some of the scholar's strengths:

One of the biggest strengths identified in the paper (as well as overall working with Odon), is the depth of the student's commitment to excellence. Odon has displayed a keen ability to thoroughly engage with research and sources to formulate and substantiate the key arguments being made. From our very first meeting, Odon approached his research with remarkable focus, clarity and dedication. He came to all our supervisory sessions well-prepared, having read widely and thoughtfully and was always ready to engage in critical discussions.

The paper is further a testament to Odon's ability to engage in critical thinking and critical analysis, as also displayed throughout our meetings and my time working with him. He showed the ability to reflect on feedback, ask thoughtful follow-up questions

and refine his arguments accordingly and this skill is thoroughly reflected throughout the paper, with a deep engagement with a wide range of sources to back up arguments and ideas raised.

2. Describe some areas in which the student can improve (e.g. in terms of skills, abilities, academic traits, etc.):

One key area for improvement from the paper is from a structural standpoint. The paper could have been better organised for a much greater coherence. There are a few stylistic inconsistencies, particularly in transitions between sections. For instance, the section on AI in Justice Systems appears before the more foundational sections on key term definitions and the literature review, a more effective structure might begin with defining the key concepts before moving into the rationale for their use, followed by the literature and case studies. Also, the research questions section could be better articulated and more logically integrated into the narrative. Additionally, it is important to choose and maintain a consistent narrative stance in academic writing. Phrasing such as “our research” (for work conducted and written predominantly independently) introduces an inconsistency in voice and the use of personal pronouns such as ‘I’ detracts from academic formality and clarity.

In terms of academic and writing skills, Odon can benefit from further development in the areas of critical analysis, argumentative clarity and editorial precision. While this paper already does a good job of attempting to analyse key issues and discussions, the paper for the future could be further strengthened by engaging with theoretical frameworks such as decolonial legal theory and post colonial theories (e.g. postcolonial governance) to push the critique to an even greater level. Additionally, some complex ideas could benefit from better unpacking and expanding as they feel a bit too broad and introduced without full interrogation.

**3. Would you recommend the scholar to a college/university admissions officer?
Please describe:**

I would strongly recommend Odon to a college admissions officer. Based on the strengths of his paper, Odon demonstrates a high level of intellectual maturity and Odon’s writing shows promise for advanced interdisciplinary research. He also demonstrates not only a capacity to analyse existing problems but also a strong orientation toward solution-building.

Odon is a committed, reflective and intellectually curious student. His paper and our meetings are a reflection of this, displaying his passion about the subject matter but also his capability of thorough independent thought. It has been a pleasure working with him and I am confident that his academic abilities, as well as his discipline and

drive, will serve him exceptionally well in future academic and professional endeavours.

Based on the quality of this work therefore, I would strongly recommend Odon for further academic opportunities, including university level study in computer science, technology governance or any study that sees an intersection on law, technology and public policy. His potential as a scholar and policy thinker is evident and with further guidance, he is likely to make a significant contribution to the future of African legal systems and digital ethics.

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